

Practice Quiz: Cognition

Part A: Pick the Best Answer

1. What is Cognition? A) Thinking and guessing B) Running fast C) Eating lunch D) Sleeping

Answer: A! Great job! Cognition is the fancy word for thinking and making guesses inside your head.

2. What did Sally see with her eyes (Perception)? A) A dinosaur B) Grey clouds C) A rainbow D) A cat

Answer: B! That's right! Sally's eyes saw grey clouds in the sky, and her brain got busy thinking about what that means.

3. What did Sally's brain guess (Cognition)? A) It will rain B) It will snow C) Aliens are coming D) Nothing

Answer: A! Smart thinking! Sally's brain used what she already knew (grey clouds = rain) to predict the future.

4. Your brain is like a: A) Toaster B) Prediction Machine C) Bucket of water D) Shoe

Answer: B! Exactly! Your brain is always predicting what will happen next, like a super-smart machine.

5. If you see smoke, what does your brain predict? A) Ice cream B) Fire C) Water D) Flowers

Answer: B! Good thinking! Your brain knows that smoke usually means fire, so it makes that prediction to keep you safe.

6. Why do we make predictions? A) To stay safe and know what to do B) To be bored C) To forget things D) Just for fun

Answer: A! That's right! Predictions help us get ready for what is coming, like grabbing a raincoat before it rains.

7. What helps you make good guesses? A) The map in your head (what you learned before) B) Closing your eyes C) Guessing randomly D) Asking a rock

Answer: A! Nice work! Your brain keeps a map of everything you have learned, and it uses that map to make good predictions.

8. What happened after Sally put on her raincoat? A) The sun came out and it was super hot B) It rained, and Sally stayed dry C) A dog ran by D) She flew away

Answer: B! Awesome! Sally's prediction was correct. It rained, but she was prepared because her brain helped her think ahead.

9. When you hear "Red, Blue, Red, Blue, Red..." what does your brain predict comes next? A) Green B) Yellow C) Blue D) Purple

Answer: C! Your brain found the pattern and predicted "Blue" comes next. That is cognition at work!

10. What happens when you learn something new? A) Your brain gets smaller B) You update the map in your head C) Nothing changes D) Your ears grow longer

Answer: B! That's right! Every time you learn something new, you add it to your brain's map so your guesses get even better.

Part B: Tell Us What You Think

1. If you see a banana peel on the floor, what do you predict will happen if you step on it?
2. Draw a "Thought Bubble" above a stick figure's head. What are they thinking?
3. How is Thinking different from Seeing?
4. Sally's Thinking Cap helped her predict rain. If you had a Thinking Cap, what would you want to predict?
5. Can you think of a time your prediction was wrong? What happened? (Maybe you thought it would be sunny, but it rained!)